



Three Purposes of the Imams



Explaining pure Islam



Clarifying the Imamate



Establishing a
just society

Maulana Syed Imon Rizvi



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***For Young Minds & Curious
Hearts***

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***In the Name of Allah,
the All-beneficent,
the All-merciful.***

Preface

While reading the life of Imām Mūsā al-Kāẓim (‘alayhis-salām) in the book “250-Year-Old Person,” I came across a paragraph that felt like a hidden treasure. In just a few lines, it beautifully summarized the 250-year-long continuous struggle of the Imams (peace be upon them) — a struggle rooted in three profound missions: to clarify pure Islam, to explain the concept of Imamate and rightful leadership, and to strive toward establishing an ideal and just society.

I felt deeply inspired to present this message in a simple, accessible format — especially for young readers — so that they may not see Islam as a set of rituals alone, but as a living, dynamic system

designed to bring justice, truth,
and divine purpose to the world.

This short booklet is presented
with that sincere intention.

— Maulana Syed Imon Rizvi
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Introduction: Who Are the Imams?

After Prophet Muḥammad (ṣallallāhu ‘alayhi wa-ālihi wa-sallam) completed his mission, Allah appointed special guides to help people stay on the right path. These guides are called Imāms (‘alayhimus-salām).

There were 12 Holy Imams, each with a very special mission. Even though their lives were in different times, their purpose was one. All of them worked together — like runners in a relay race — to carry the light of Islam for 250 years!

Their Mission Had Three Big Goals:

1. Explaining the Real Islam

Imagine hearing many people say different things about a game you love — but only one person actually knows the real rules! The Imams were like that trusted person who knew the pure Islam taught by the Prophet.

- They explained the true meaning of the Qur'ān.
- They protected Islam from wrong ideas and fake teachings.
- They made sure people understood what Allah really wanted from them — in simple, beautiful ways.



Example: Imām al-Bāqir and Imām aṣ-Ṣādiq (‘alayhim-as-salām) taught thousands of students and explained thousands of aḥkām (laws) and meanings of verses.



Why it matters: Without their explanation, we might have forgotten the real teachings of Islam.



2. Explaining Imamate and Leadership

The Imams were not only teachers — they were the true leaders chosen by Allah. But some people didn't want them to lead because they wanted power for themselves.

So, the Imams:

- Spoke clearly about who should lead the Muslims.
- Explained that Imamate (being an Imām) is not about popularity — it's about being divinely chosen.
- Showed the difference between real leaders (like Imām 'Alī and his sons) and fake ones who just wanted control.



Example: Imām Ḥasan ('alayhis-salām) made a peace

treaty to protect Islam, showing deep wisdom about leadership. Imām Ḥusayn (‘alayhis-salām) stood up bravely in Karbala to say “No!” to injustice.



Why it matters: Leadership in Islam is about justice, truth, and God — not power and money.



3. Building a Just and Loving Society

The Imams wanted to create a world where:

- People are treated with fairness and kindness.
- Justice is everywhere — no one is bullied, poor, or alone.
- Truth wins, and oppression is defeated.
- Idols are removed — not just statues, but anything that people wrongly follow instead of God.



Example: The Imams spent their lives helping the poor, freeing slaves, feeding the hungry, and teaching with mercy.



Final Goal: To prepare a perfect society — one that will be

completed when our Imām al-Mahdī (‘ajjalallāhu farajah) appears and spreads justice everywhere.



Why it matters: The Imams showed us how to live Islam, not just talk about it. They wanted us to be kind, wise, and brave like them.



Conclusion: Our Role Today

Even though those 250 years are over, the mission continues — with us!

◆ We must learn the true Islam from the Qur'ān and the Ahlulbayt.

◆ We must understand what real leadership means.

◆ We must work — in small or big ways — to build a world of kindness, knowledge, and justice.

And one day, we will welcome Imām al-Mahdī (‘alayhis-salām) to finish the mission that began over 1400 years ago.



Words to Remember:

Imām: A guide chosen by Allah.

Imamate: The divine leadership after the Prophet.

Justice: Treating everyone fairly.

Oppression: Being unfair or hurting others.

Idols: Anything we follow instead of Allah.